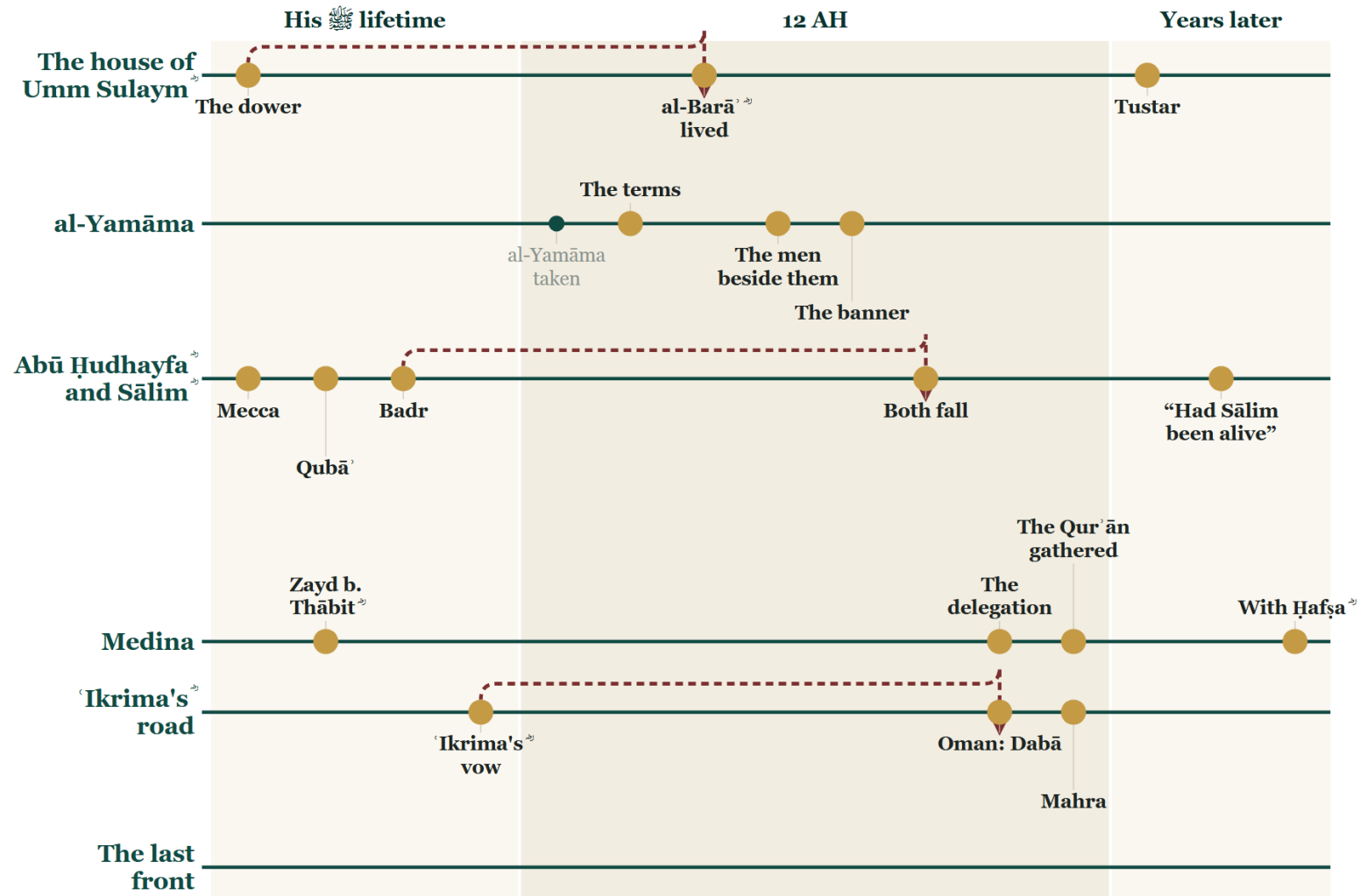


Evening 6

Right and left

11–12 AH

Where we stopped



From last week

Where we stand



Oman, Mahra
settled

Ḥaḍramawt
still to come

Part I

Right and left (the frame)

12 opens, the whole peninsula

The year opens with the armies still out

IMAGE GOES HERE

A restrained editorial illustration for: Ibn Kathīr does not open his chapter for the year 12 with an event. He opens it with a situation. The year came in, he writes, with al-Ṣiddīq's armies and.... Landscape, architecture

11, as the eleven commanders rode...

The march to Khaybar that never happened

واعده أنّه سيلقاهُ من ناحيةٍ خير بمن معه من الأمراء - وأظهروا ذلك ليرعبوا
الأعرابَ

*"He promised him that he would meet him from the direction of
Khaybar with the commanders who were with him..."*

11, before Dhu al-Qassa — the...

Khālīd b. Saʿīd ُ — a banner, and no...

وَتَوَسَّطَتْ خَيْلُ أُسَامَةَ بِلَادِ قُضَاعَةَ، فَشَنَّ الْغَارَةَ فِيهِمْ، فَغَنِمُوا وَعَادُوا سَالِمِينَ

"And Usāma's cavalry pushed into the middle of the country of Quḍāʿa, and he loosed the raid among them, and they took spoil and came back safe."

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 201

11, and the south-western highlands...

Jundub b. Salmā, and three more

IMAGE GOES HERE

A restrained editorial illustration for: Four small actions in the south-west, and every one of them was run by a man who was already there. ‘Attāb b. Asīd ٱ wrote to Abū Bakr ٱ from.... Landscape, architecture, objects or

Part II

Bahrayn: the front that started first (11→12 AH)

Meanwhile, in the east

Last week

we followed one man's
road east, front by
front

Tonight

we go back once — to
the front that started
before all of them

Then

forward, to the last
one

al-Mundhir b. Sāwā ُ — and the king

they...

وَاجْتَمَعَتْ رِبِيعَةُ بِالْبَحْرَيْنِ عَلَى الرِّدَّةِ إِلَّا الْجَارُودَ وَمَنْ تَبِعَهُ، وَقَالُوا: نَرُدُّ الْمُلْكَ

"And Rabī'a in Bahrayn agreed together upon the ridda — except al-Jārūd and those who followed him — and they said: we will restore the kingship."

11

al-Ḥuṭam b. Ḍubayʿa



al-Qaṭīf, Hajar

taken

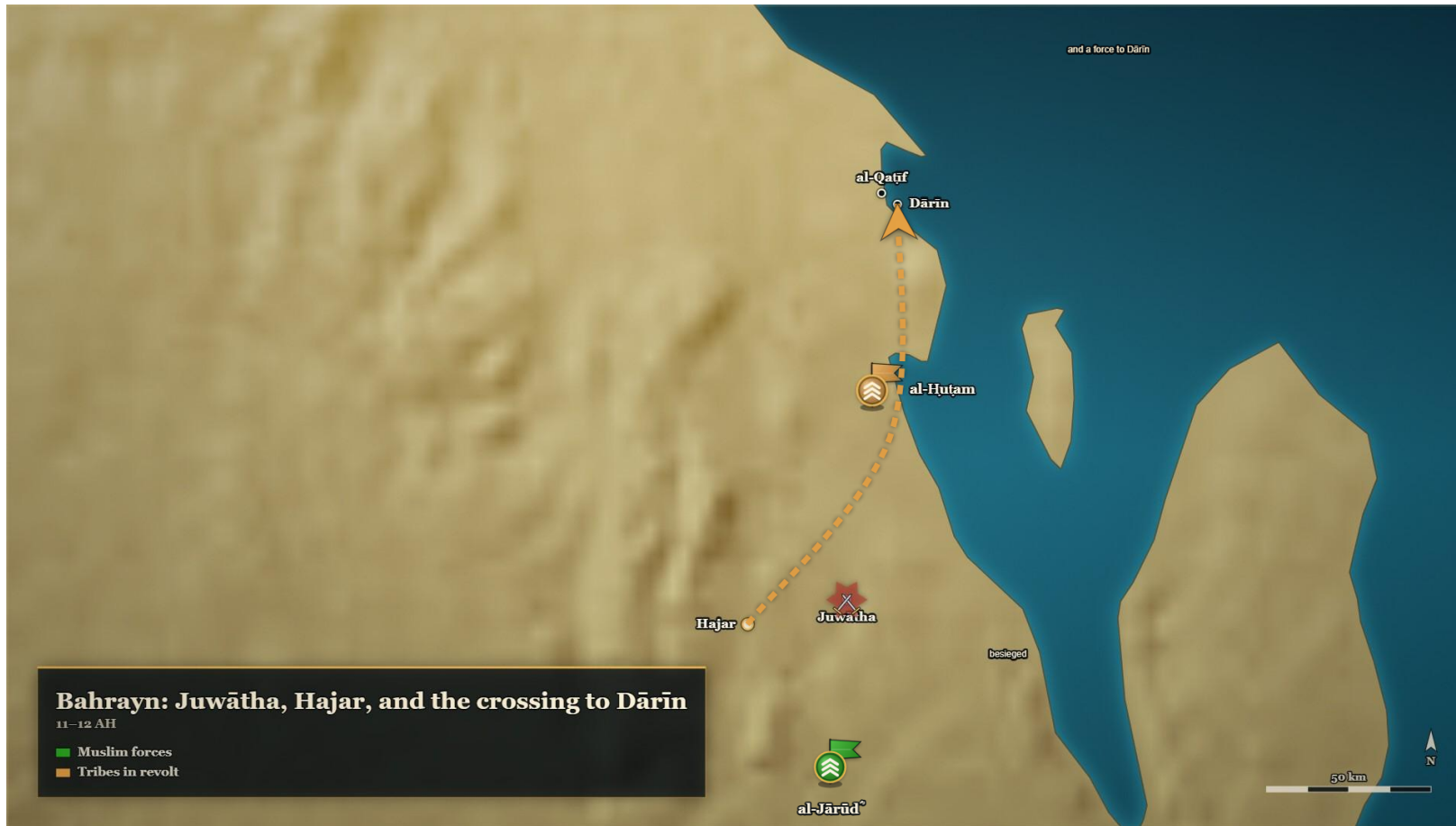
al-Khaṭṭ

drawn in

al-Ḥuṭam b. Ḍubay‘a

وَخَرَجَ الْحُطَمُ بْنُ ضُبَيْعَةَ أَخُو بَنِي قَيْسٍ بْنِ ثَعْلَبَةَ فِي بَكْرِ بْنِ وَائِلٍ، فَاجْتَمَعَ إِلَيْهِ
مِنْ غَيْرِ الْمُرْتَدِّينَ مِمَّنْ لَمْ يَزَلْ مُشْرِكًا

"And al-Ḥuṭam b. Ḍubay‘a, of Banū Qays b. Tha‘laba, went out at the head of Bakr b. Wā’il..."



Juwātha
besieged

‘Abd al-Qays
hold, behind al-
Jārūd

أَلَا أُبَلِّغُ أَبَا بَكْرٍ رَسُولًا ... وَفِتْيَانَ الْمَدِينَةِ أَجْمَعِينَ فَهَلْ لَكُمْ إِلَى قَوْمٍ كِرَامٍ ...
قُعُودٍ فِي جُؤَاثَا مُحْصَرِينَ

"Take a message to Abū Bakr, and to all the young men of Medina: have you any thought for a noble people, sitting besieged in Juwāthā?"

al-Jārūd b. al-Mu‘allā

فَإِنَّ مُحَمَّدًا ﷺ مَاتَ كَمَا مَاتُوا، وَإِنِّي أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ

اللَّهُ

"Muḥammad ﷺ has died just as they died — and I bear witness that there is no god but Allah and that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah."

al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥaḍramī ۞ — the sixteen



The sixteen
from Medina

al-Dahnā’
the camels, then the
water

al-‘Alā’ b. al-Ḥadramī ُ — the sixteen

فَخَرَجَ مِنَ الْمَدِينَةِ فِي سِتَّةَ عَشَرَ رَاكِبًا، وَكَتَبَ لَهُ كِتَابًا: أَنْ يَنْفِرَ مَعَهُ كُلُّ مَنْ مَرَّ
بِهِ مِنَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ إِلَى عَدُوِّهِمْ.

*"He left Medina with sixteen riders, and he wrote him a letter:
that every Muslim he passed should march out with him against
their enemy."*

Ibn Ḥadhaf, at the trench



al-Jārūd

comes up the other side

Hajar

a month, dug in

Ibn Ḥadhf, at the trench

فَدَخَلَ عَسْكَرَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ فَأَخْبَرَهُمْ أَنَّ الْقَوْمَ سُكَارَى، فَخَرَجَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ عَلَيْهِمْ،
فَوَضَعُوا فِيهِمُ السَّيْفَ كَيْفَ شَاءُوا.

"He entered the Muslims' camp and told them that the people were drunk. So the Muslims went out at them and put the sword into them as they pleased."

Abjar b. Bujayr — his uncle

وَاللَّهِ إِنِّي لَأَظُنُّكَ بِعُسِّ ابْنِ أُخْتٍ أَتَيْتَ اللَّيْلَةَ أَخُوَالَكَ

"By Allāh, I think you a poor sort of sister's-son, coming to your uncles tonight."

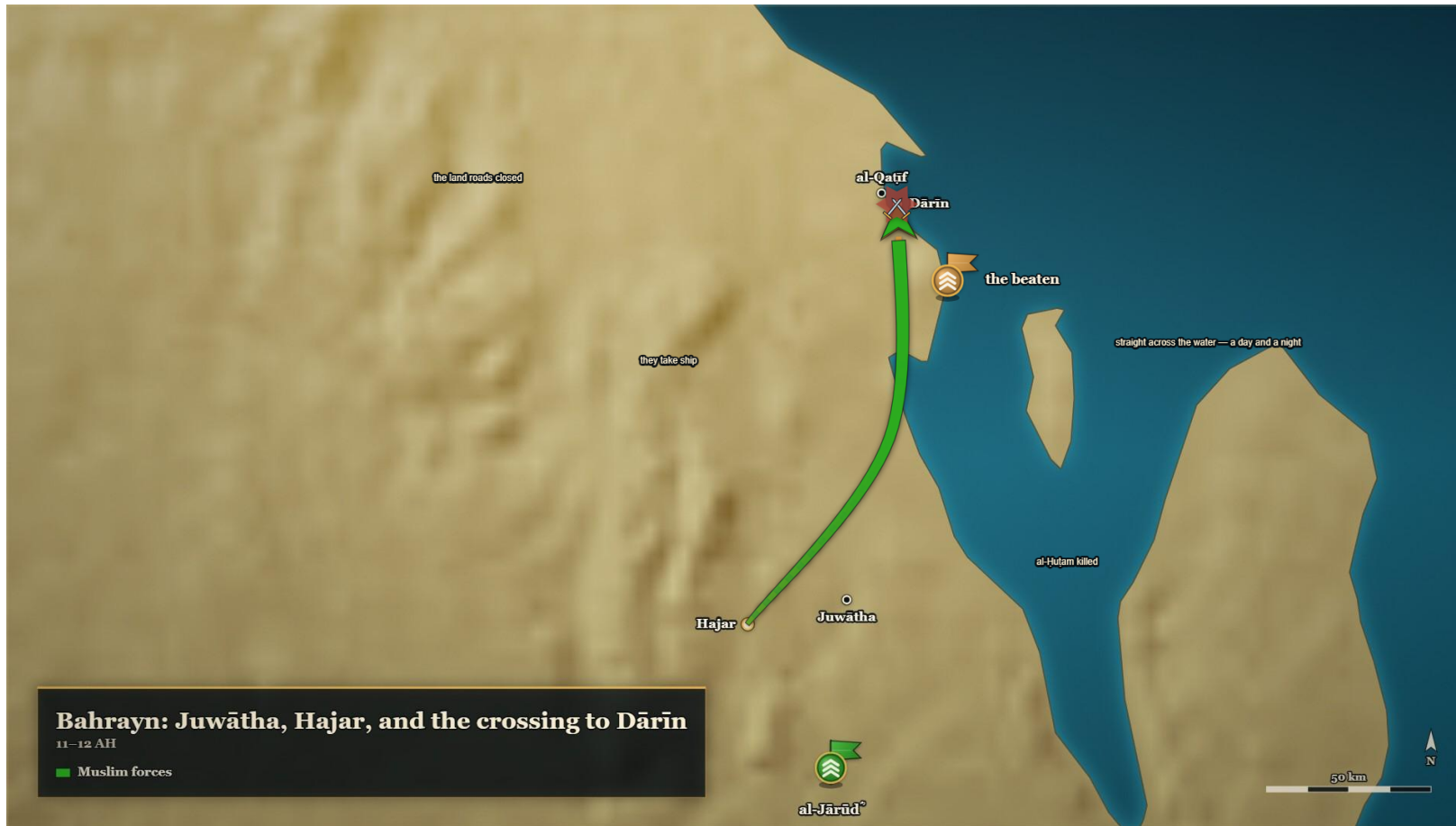
Qays b. 'Āṣim, over al-Ḥuṭam

واسوأته، لو أعلم ما به لم أحرّكه

"What a shameful thing — had I known his condition, I would not have touched him."

11→12

Dārīn



Dārīn

a day and a night
by ship

The land roads
closed behind them

وَضَرَبَ الْإِسْلَامُ فِيهَا بِجَرَانِهِ.

"And Islam settled its neck to the ground there." — the image is a camel kneeling and setting its neck down to stay: the front was not held, it was finished.

The monk of Hajar

ثَلَاثَةُ أَشْيَاءَ خَشِيتُ أَنْ يَمْسَخَنِي اللَّهُ بَعْدَهَا: فَيْضٌ فِي الرِّمَالِ، وَتَمْهِيدُ أَثْبَاجِ
الْبَحْرِ، وَدُعَاءُ سَمِعْتُهُ فِي عَسْكَرِهِمْ فِي الْهَوَاءِ سَحَرًا

*"Three things, after which I feared Allah would transform me:
water welling up in the sands, the levelling of the sea's swells,
and a supplication I heard in..."*

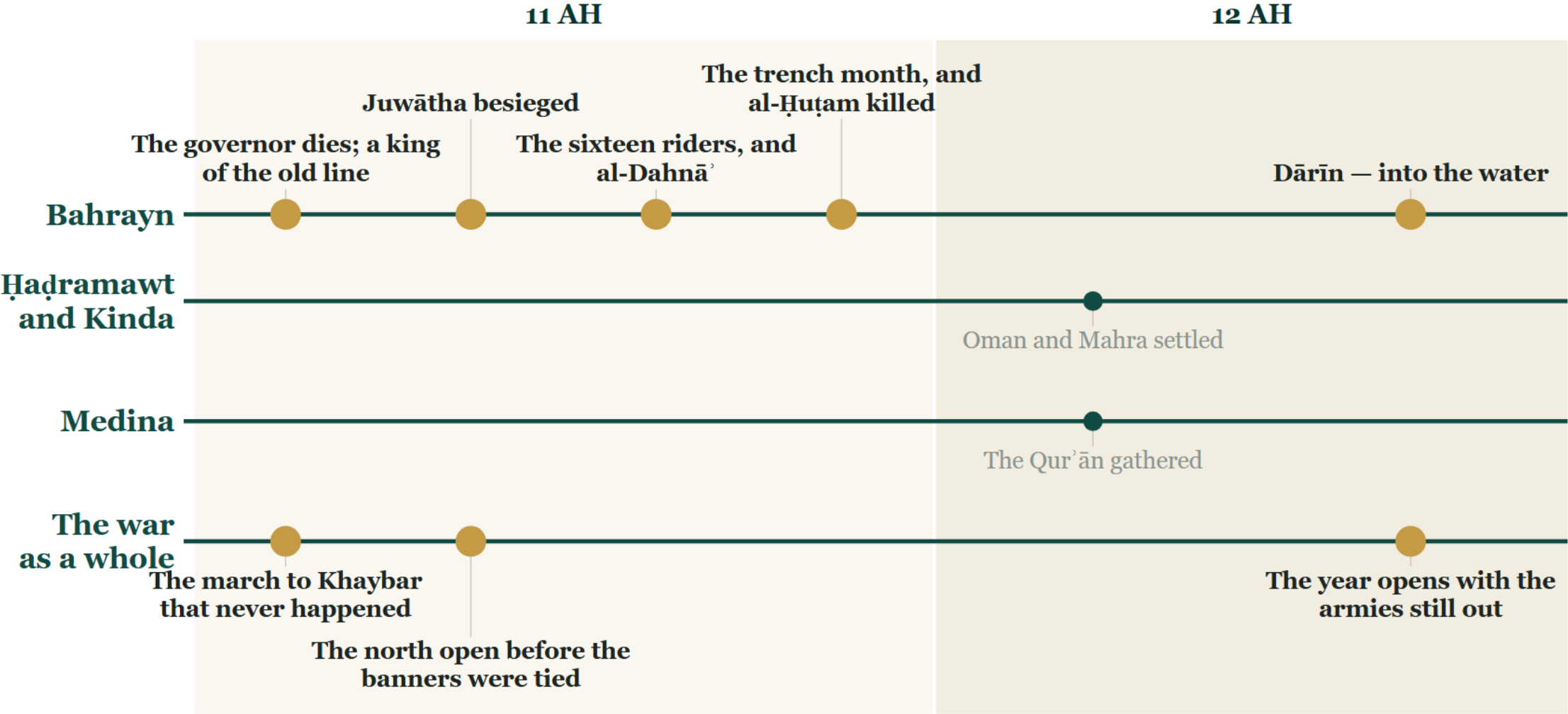
Thumāma b. Uthāl

فَقَالُوا لَهُ: أَنْتَ قَتَلْتَ الْحُطَمَ! فَقَالَ: لَمْ أَقْتُلْهُ، وَلَكِنِّي اشْتَرَيْتُهَا مِنَ الْمَغْنَمِ.
فَوَثَبُوا عَلَيْهِ فَقَتَلُوهُ.

"They said to him: You killed al-Ḥuṭam! He said: I did not kill him — I bought it from the spoils. So they fell on him and killed him."

So far tonight

Where we stand



So far tonight

Where we stand



Bahrayn
settled

Ḥaḍramawt
still to come

Part III

Kinda, before any of it (10 AH)

10 AH, Medina

Before any of this

**Two years
earlier**

a delegation comes to
Medina

At its head

a man the room will
meet again tonight

Then

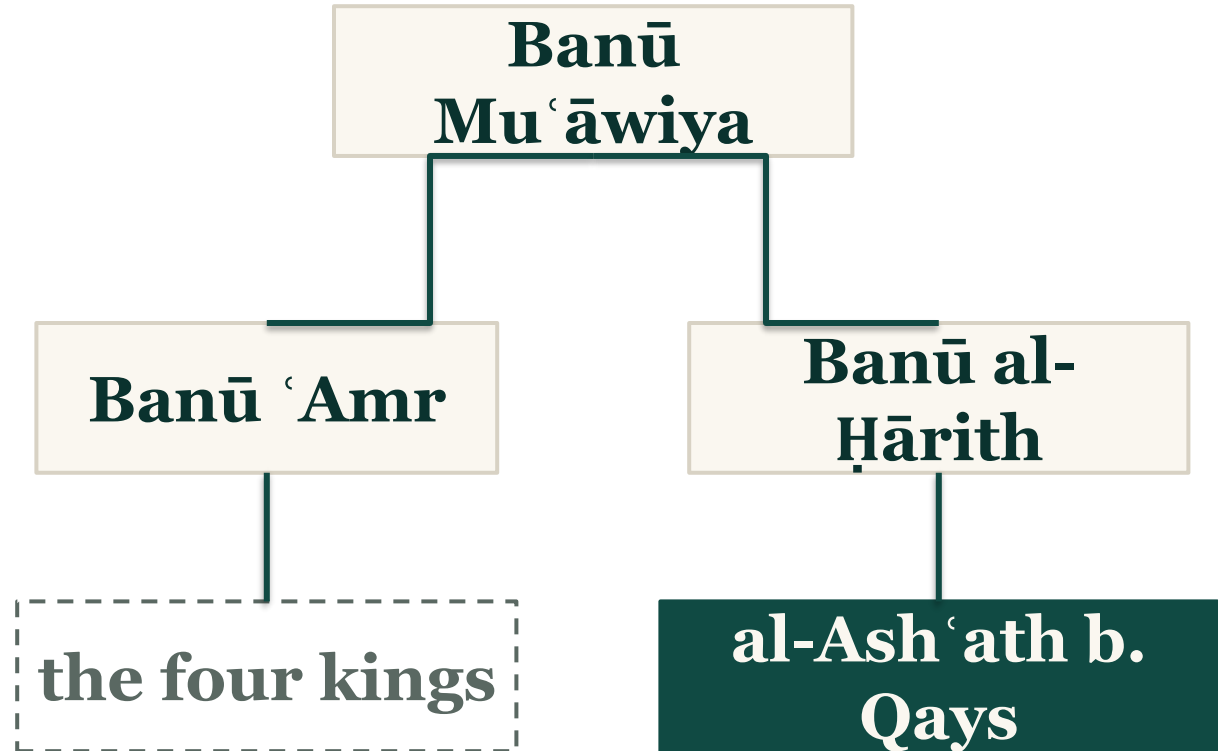
forward again, and we
do not go back

kings once — and two branches in 11 AH

Kinda

Ākil al-Murār

kings of the north,
before Islam



10 AH, Medina

al-Ash'ath b. Qays — at Medina

لا، نحن بنو النَّضْر بن كنانة، لا نَقْفُو أُمَّنَا، ولا ننتفي من أيينا

"No. We are the sons of al-Naḍr b. Kināna. We do not trace ourselves through our mother, and we do not disown our father."

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 5, p. 56

Part IV

Ḥaḍramawt: the last front (11 → 12 AH)

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Ziyād b. Labīd[ؓ], in Ḥaḍramawt



Ḥaḍramawt

Ziyād b. Labīd[ؓ], the Prophet's ﷺ governor

Kinda

its neighbour

Ziyād b. Labīdٌ , in Ḥaḍramawt

قَالَتْ بَنُو وَلِيْعَةَ: أَبْلِغُونَا كَمَا وَعَدْتُمْ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ - صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ - !

فَقَالُوا: إِنَّ لَكُمْ ظَهْرًا فَاحْتَمِلُوا

"Banū Walī'a said: Deliver it to us, as you promised the Messenger of Allah ﷺ! They said: You do have mounts — carry it yourselves."

Ziyād b. Labīd ُ — and Shadhra

فَقَالَ حَارِثَةُ: ذَاكَ إِذَا كُنْتَ يَهُودِيًّا، وَأَطْلَقَ عِقَالَهَا وَبَعَثَهَا وَقَامَ دُونَهَا.

"Ḥāritha said: That would be so if you were a Jew — and he untied her hobble and drove her off and stood in front of her."

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-‘Addā’, and Ḥāritha b. Surāqa



Ziyād's ٱ camp
Ḥaḍramawt and al-Sakūn

Banū
of Kinda
Mu‘āwiya

al-‘Addā’, and Ḥāritha b. Surāqa

فَنَادَى الْعَدَاءُ: يَا آلَ عَمْرٍو، أَضَامُ وَأُضْطَهَدُ! إِنَّ الدَّلِيلَ مَنْ أَكِلَ فِي دَارِهِ!

"Al-‘Addā’ called out: O family of ‘Amr — am I to be wronged and trampled? The humbled man is the one who is devoured in his own home!"

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

Shuraḥbīl b. al-Simt, and his son



The pastures
each chief's, held as
a stronghold

Shuraḥbīl
and his son, to
Ziyād

Shuraḥbīl b. al-Simt, and his son

إِنَّهُ لَقَبِيحٌ بِالْأَحْرَارِ التَّنَقُّلُ، إِنَّ الْكِرَامَ لَيَلْزِمُونَ الشُّبُهَةَ فَيَتَكَرَّمُونَ أَنْ يَنْتَقِلُوا إِلَى
أَوْضَحَ مِنْهَا مَخَافَةَ الْعَارِ، فَكَيْفَ الْإِنْتِقَالُ مِنَ الْأَمْرِ الْحَسَنِ الْجَمِيلِ وَالْحَقِّ إِلَى
الْبَاطِلِ وَالْقَبِيحِ!

"It is an ugly thing in free men to change sides. Men of honour will stay with a doubtful position, and..."

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

The four kings — Mikhwaṣ, Mishraḥ, Jamad, Abdaʿa



Banū ʿAmr
the strongest of
Kinda

The four kings
killed at their fires

11-12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

The four kings — Mikhwaṣ, Mishraḥ, Jamad, Abḍa‘a

فَوَجَدُوهُمْ جُلُوسًا حَوْلَ نِيرَانِهِمْ، فَأَكْبُوا عَلَى بَنِي عَمْرِو بْنِ مُعَاوِيَةَ، وَفِيهِمُ الْعَدَدُ
وَالشُّوْكَةُ - مِنْ خَمْسَةِ أَوْجِهٍ

*"They found them sitting round their fires, and fell on Banū
‘Amr b. Mu‘āwiya — who had the numbers and the strength —
from five directions."*

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-Ash‘ath b. Qays — the column he

stopped



The column
the property and
the captives

**al-Ash‘ath b.
Qays**
of the other branch

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-Ash‘ath b. Qays — the column he stopped

وَعَادَ زِيَادُ بْنُ لَبِيدٍ بِالْأَمْوَالِ وَالسَّبْيِ، وَاجْتَاوُوا بِالْأَشْعَثِ، فَتَارَ فِي قَوْمِهِ،
فَاسْتَنْقَذَهُمْ وَجَمَعَ الْجُمُوعَ.

*"Ziyād b. Labīd returned with the property and the captives,
and they passed by al-Ash‘ath..."*

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-Muhājir ٱ and ʿIkrima ٱ — to al-Nujayr



al-Muhājir ٱ
from Ṣanʿāʾ, ahead
of his army

ʿIkrima ٱ
with the main body

al-Nujayr
the fort

11–12 AH, Ḥaḍramawt

al-Muhājir ۞ and ‘Ikrima ۞ — to al-Nujayr

فَرَجَعُوا إِلَىٰ حِصْنِهِمْ، وَخَشَعَتْ نُفُوسُهُمْ وَخَافُوا الْقَتْلَ

"They went back into their fort; their spirits sank, and they feared death."

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 231

11 or 12 AH, al-Nujayr

al-Ash‘ath b. Qays — and Jaḥdam

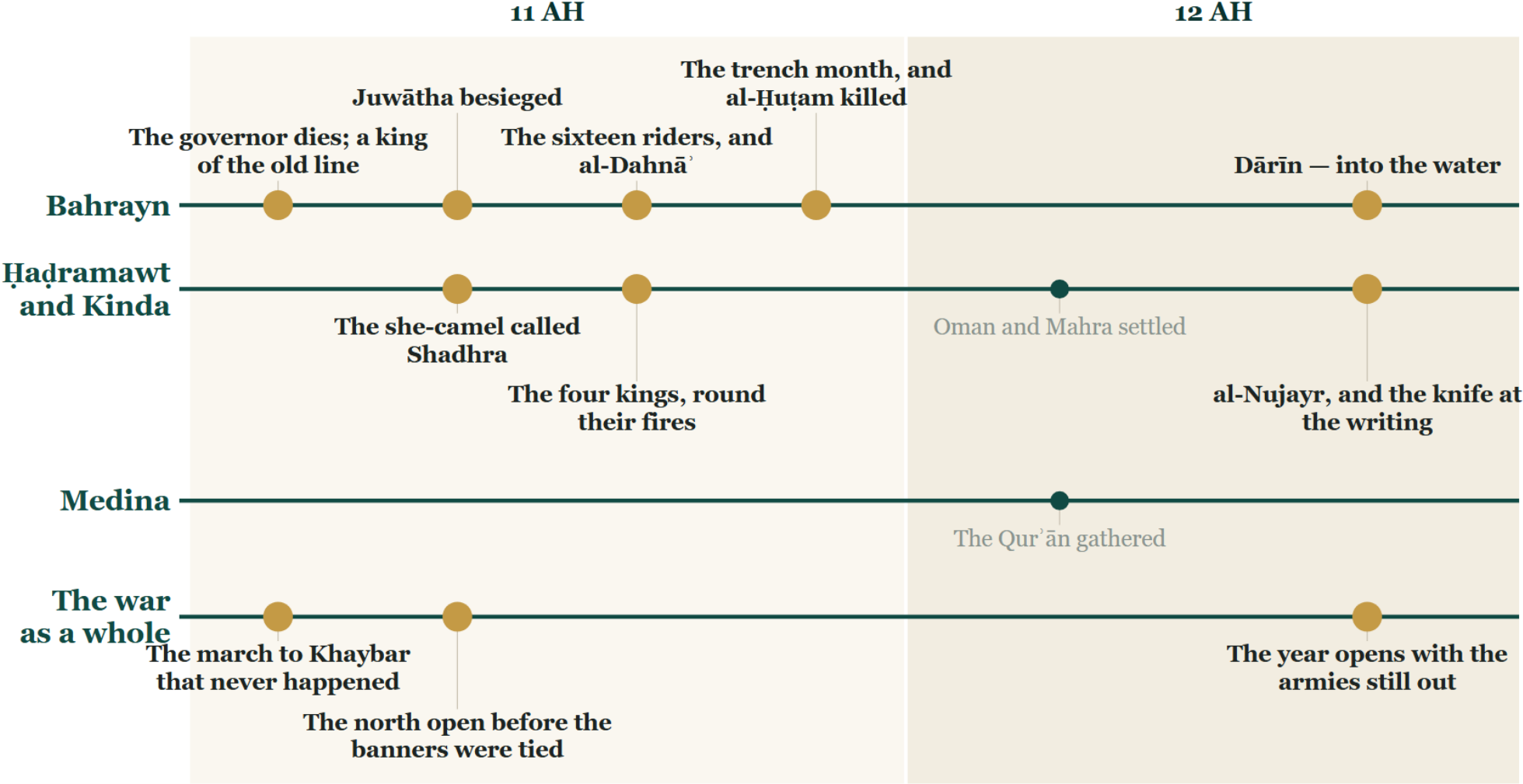
وَنَسِيَ الْأَشْعَثُ أَنْ يَكْتُبَ نَفْسَهُ لِأَنَّ جَحْدَمًا وَثَبَ عَلَيْهِ بِسِكِّينٍ، فَقَالَ:
تَكْتُبُنِي أَوْ أَقْتُلُكَ؟ فَكَتَبَهُ وَنَسِيَ نَفْسَهُ

"Al-Ash‘ath forgot to write himself in, because Jaḥdam leapt at him with a knife and said: Will you write me in, or shall I kill you?..."

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 232

So far tonight

Where we stand



So far tonight

Where we stand



| **al-Nujayr**
opened

| **al-Ash‘ath**
in bonds, for
Medina

Part V

Medina, and after (12 AH → years later)

Abū Bakr ٱ and al-Ash'ath, at Medina

قَالَ: إِنَّمَا وَجِبَ الصُّلْحُ بَعْدَ خَتْمِ الصَّحِيفَةِ عَلَى مَنْ فِيهَا، وَإِنَّمَا كُنْتُ قَبْلَ ذَلِكَ مُرَاوِضًا.

"He said: The peace became binding, once the document was sealed, only on those named in it; before that you were only negotiating."

al-Ash'ath ُ — pardoned, and married

وَاللّٰهُ مَا كَفَرْتُ؛ وَلَكِنَّ هَٰذَا الرَّجُلَ زَوَّجَنِي أُخْتَهُ؛ وَلَوْ كُنَّا فِي بِلَادِنَا لَكَانَتْ لَنَا
وَلِيْمَةٌ غَيْرُ هَٰذِهِ، يَا أَهْلَ الْمَدِيْنَةِ، انْحَرُوا، وَكُلُّوْا! وَيَا أَهْلَ الْإِبِلِ تَعَالَوْا خُذُوا
شَرَوَاهَا!

"By God, I have not disbelieved. This man has married his sister to me, and had we been in our own..."

Years later: al-Qādisiyya, Nahāwand

Ṭulayḥa ُ • ‘Amr b. Ma‘dī Karib ُ •...

ولقد اتهمنا ثلاثة نفر، فما رأينا كما هجمنا عليهم من أمانتهم وزهدهم:
طليحة بن خويلد الأسدي، وعَمْرُو بن معدي كرب، وقيس بن المكشوح.

"We did suspect three men — and when we came upon them we found nothing to match their trustworthiness..."

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 243

Years later

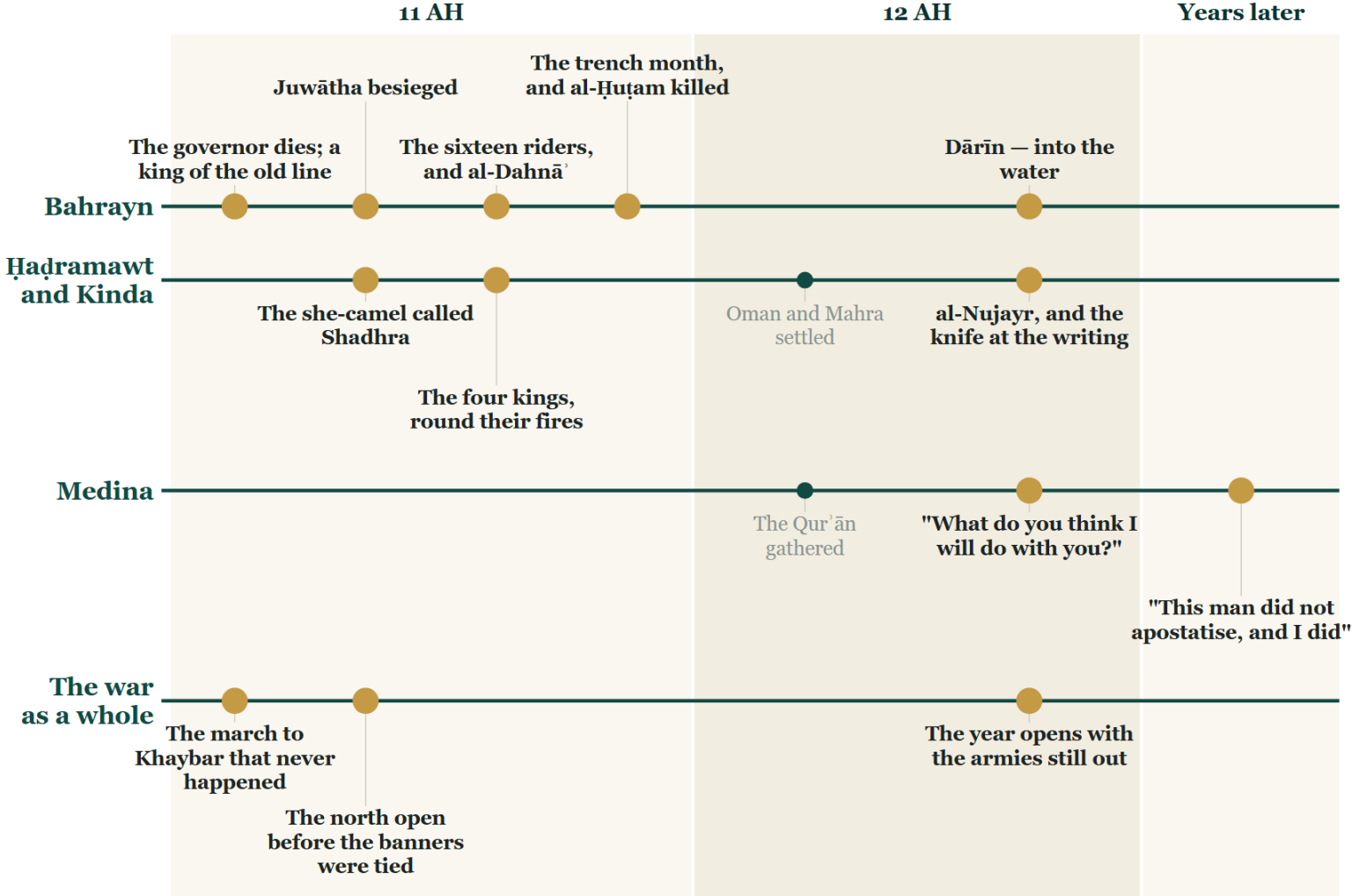
al-Ash'ath ُ and Jarīr b. 'Abd Allāhُ

إِنَّ هَذَا لَمْ يَرْتَدَّ، وَإِنِّي ارْتَدَدْتُ.

"This man did not apostatise. And I did."

So far tonight

Where we stand



So far tonight

Where we stand



Every front
settled

One man
who came back

Part VI

Who did not break away (11 AH)

The same year, looked at sideways

So far

every front, one after
another

Now

the same months —
and who did not break
at all

The question

what made the
difference?

11; the delegation was in ...

Thaqīf, at al-Ṭā'if

وقد كانت ثقيف بالطائف ثبتوا على الإسلام، لم يفرُّوا ولا ارتدّوا

"Thaqīf at Ṭā'if had stood firm upon Islam: they did not flee and they did not apostatise."

أَرْسَلُوا وَفْدًا لِيُجَدِّدُوا عَهْدَهُمْ مَعَ أَبِي بَكْرٍ، فَكَتَبَ بِذَلِكَ كِتَابًا

"They sent a delegation to renew their covenant with Abū Bakr, and he wrote a document to that effect."

Banū Tamīm — three answers

كانت بنو تميم قد اختلفت أراؤهم أيام الرِّدَّة، فمنهم من ارتدَّ ومنع الزكاة،
ومنهم من بعثَ بأموالِ الصَّدقات إلى الصَّدِيق، ومنهم من توقف لينظر في
أمره.

*"The views of Banū Tamīm differed in the days of the ridda:
some of them apostatised and withheld the..."*

The verse from the other side

أَطَعْنَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ إِذْ كَانَ بَيْنَنَا . . . فَوَاعَجَبًا مَا بَالُ مُلْكِ أَبِي بَكْرٍ

"We obeyed the Messenger of Allah while he was among us — so how strange: what is this about the rule of Abū Bakr?"

The Azd — Medina, and Oman

فنبغ فيهم رجلٌ يقال له: ذو التاج لقيطُ بن مالك الأزدي، وكان يُسمَّى في
الجاهلية الجُلندى، فادّعى النبوة أيضًا

"There arose among them a man called Dhū al-Tāj, Laqīṭ b. Mālik al-Azdī — who used to be called al-Julandā in the Jāhiliyya — and he too claimed prophethood."

Part VII

The last word (12 AH)

« ...

Ibn Kathīr, on the whole war

IMAGE GOES HERE

A restrained editorial illustration for: When Ibn Kathīr finishes the whole account, he stops and sums it up himself. He does not describe a conquest. He says there was no region of Arabia in which.... Landscape, architect

11, looking back

‘Abd Allāh b. Mas‘ūdؓ

IMAGE GOES HERE

A restrained editorial illustration for: Ibn al-Athīr opens his whole account of the Ridda not with an event but with a Companion's verdict on it. ‘Abd Allāh b. Mas‘ūd ؓ says that after the Messenger.... Landscape, archite

Abū Bakrؓ , and the men of Badr

لَا أَسْتَعْمِلُ أَهْلَ بَدْرٍ، أَدْعُهُمْ حَتَّى يَلْقُوا اللَّهَ بِصَالِحِ أَعْمَالِهِمْ، فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ يَدْفَعُ بِهِمْ
وَبِالصَّالِحِينَ أَكْثَرَ مِمَّا يَنْتَصِرُ بِهِمْ. وَكَانَ عُمَرُ يَرَى اسْتِعْمَالَهُمْ عَلَى الْجُنْدِ وَغَيْرِهِ.

"I do not put the men of Badr into office. I leave them so they may meet Allah with their good deeds..."

The eleven banners

IMAGE GOES HERE

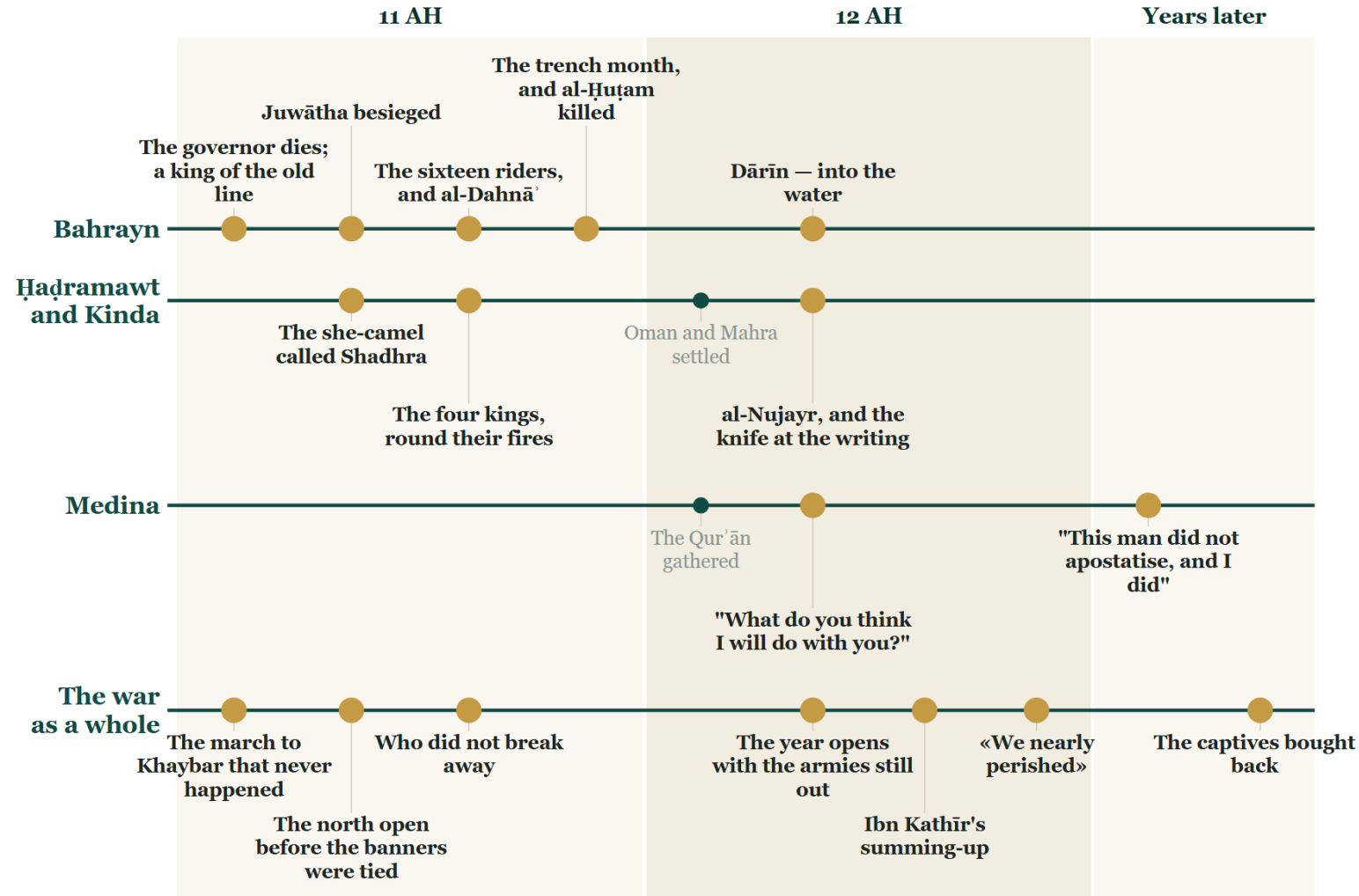
A restrained editorial illustration for: In a single sitting at Dhū al-Qaṣṣa, one day's ride from Medina, Abū Bakr ٱ tied eleven banners and gave each commander a region. The two books disagree on the.... Landscape, archit

**eleven arrows out
of...**

In a single sitting at Dhū al-Qaṣṣa, one...

So far tonight

Where we stand



So far tonight

Where we stand



The Ridda
whole

Eleven
every sector settled
banners

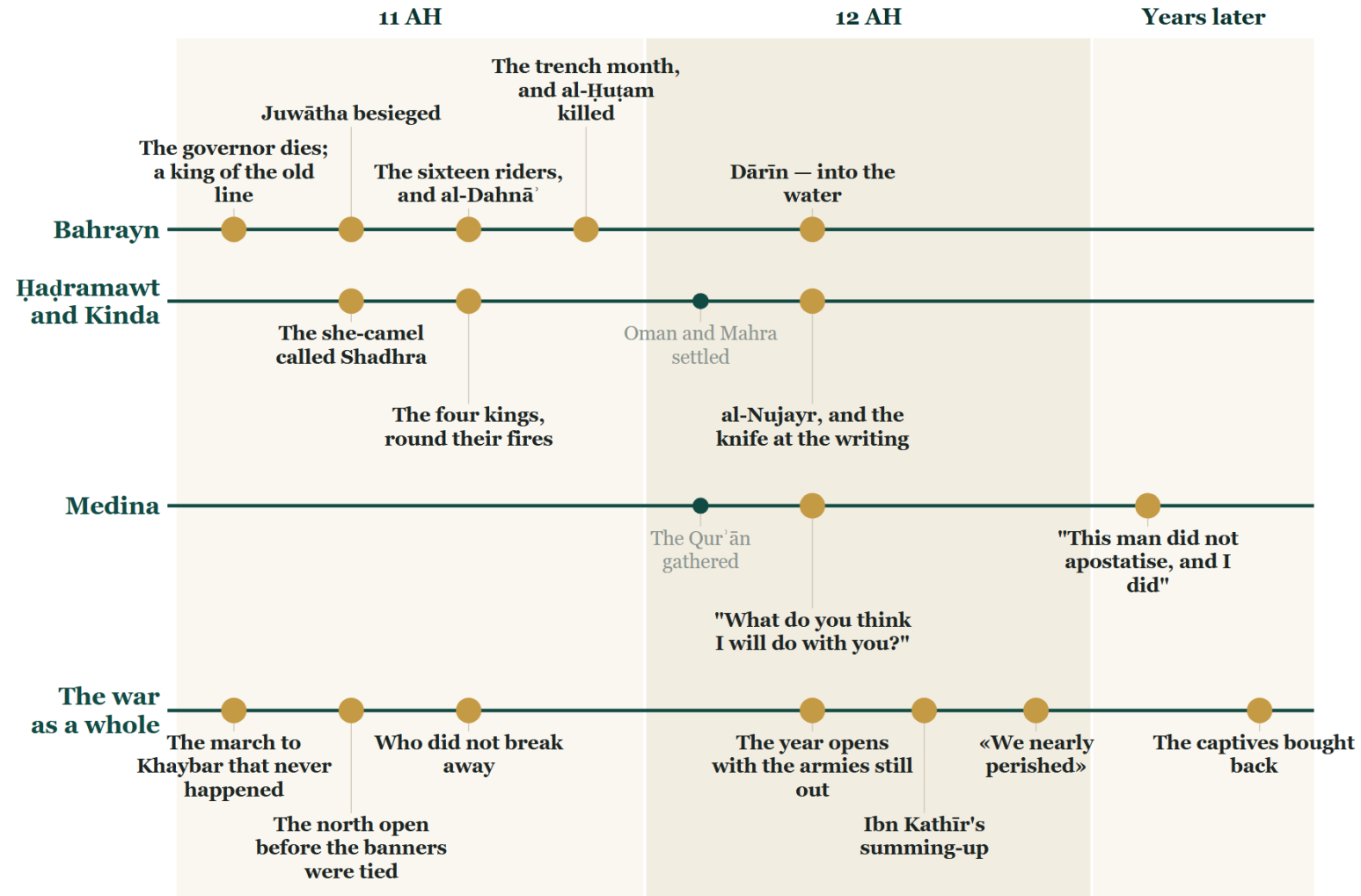
in 'Umar's ﷺ caliphate —...

'Umar ﷺ — the captives bought back

إِنَّهُ لَقَبِيحٌ بِالْعَرَبِ أَنْ يَمْلِكَ بَعْضُهُمْ بَعْضًا

"It is a shameful thing for the Arabs that some of them should own others."

Tonight on the Line



12 AH

Where we stand



Tonight

the last two fronts,
and the whole war

Next week

the other side of
the desert

Tonight

- | Right and left
- | The front that started first
- | The last front
- | The man who came back
- | What the whole of it was

Next week

Two years after the Prophet ﷺ died, every man in Arabia was on the same side.

There were two empires on the other side of the desert. Did either of them know?

Part VIII

Why it did not break again

Ibn Khaldūn — as he reads it

IMAGE GOES HERE

A restrained editorial illustration for: Ibn Khaldūn asks the question anyone looking at the map of the year eleven would ask.
How does a peninsula that has just fragmented move against two empires within two.... Landscape